

6 followers, presumably, defend a version of this view.¹⁰ Maṇḍana interprets this theory in two ways (VVS §§4-5). On the first interpretation, this linguistic operation is designated or directly conveyed (*abhidheya*) by exhortative verbal endings: when a linguistically competent agent hears an exhortative verbal ending, she becomes aware of the linguistic operation in question, and thereby performs the relevant action. On the second interpretation, designation (*abhidhā*), i.e., the operation by means of which linguistic expressions directly convey their meanings to linguistically competent hearers, itself is the motivating linguistic operation. It is unclear which of these two views is actually the view Kumārila endorses. Finally, according to a semantic approach (*arthavidhivāda*), a *vidhi* is just an extralinguistic object that constitutes the meaning of exhortative verbal endings and motivates a hearer to act under suitable circumstances (VVS §§6-7). Prabhākara Miśra and his followers, arguably, defend a semantic theory of *vidhi*.¹¹ In the first negative half of VV, Maṇḍana considers all three approaches to *vidhi*, and discusses arguments against them. In the second half, he offers his own semantic theory of *vidhi*. In the rest of this section, I sketch his preferred theory of *vidhi*. Focus just on the imperatives (2)-(4). These are of different kinds: the first is an order (*ājñā*), the second is a request (*abhyarthanā*), and the third is a permission (*anujñā*). Ordinary exhortations like (2)-(4) are issued by an enjoiner (*niyoktr*) who prompts another agent, i.e., the enjinee (*niyojya*), to act. Notice that an enjoiner typically uses orders and requests to make the enjinee perform an action that will promote her own interests. For example, if a farmer orders her assistant to bring the cow (so that the cow can be milked), she does so because it helps her satisfy a standing desire she has. Similarly, if I request you to teach my son, I may do so because that action serves my interests. Things are different with permissions. For example, if my nephew asks me if he can get an ice-cream and I ask him to do whatever he likes, it is not obvious that I am thereby

¹⁰ This operation is sometimes called *śabdātmikā bhāvanā* (literally, verbal effectuation). See Kumārila's *Tantravārttika* on *Mīmāṃsāsūtra* 2.1.1 (TV II.344.14-16): "Of those, that operation, which belongs to linguistic expressions like exhortative verbal endings and which motivates a person towards object-directed effectuation (*arthātmikā bhāvanā*), is the second kind of effectuation (*bhāvanā*), which is a property of linguistic expressions, which has the nature of designation (*abhidhā*), and which is said to be the *vidhi*." (*tatrārthātmikāyām bhāvānāyām liṅādīśabdānām yah puruṣam prati prayojakavyāpārah, sā dvitīyā śabdadharmo 'bhidhātmikā bhāvanā vidhir ucyate* |)

¹¹ Throughout this essay, I will take the meaning (*artha*) of any linguistic expression (roughly, speaking) to be the object that is conveyed to a linguistically competent hearer by that expression. On the Prabhākara view that Maṇḍana presents, the meaning of exhortative verbal endings is *niyoga* or injunction, also referred to as *apūrva* (VVS §7, or VVMG 36-78). When an agent hears an exhortative verbal ending in the context of an exhortation addressed to her, she undergoes an awareness-event of the form: "I am enjoined" (*niyukto 'smi*). Such self-ascriptions are supposed to track an entity called injunction—according to one interpretation, something to be done or brought about—which is not accessible by any means of knowing other than language, and, unlike other entities that are part of the natural fabric of reality, does not exist in the past, the present, or the future. For discussion of this view in its sources, see Prabhākara Miśra's sub-commentary *Bṛhatī* on *Mīmāṃsāsūtra* 2.1.5 along with Śālikanātha Miśra's *Rjuvimalā* (Br 319- 324) and the second chapter of Śālikanātha's *Vākyārthamātrkā* in *Prakaraṇapañcikā* (PP 417-450). For discussion of Prabhākara's view, see Clooney (1990, pp. 245ff) and Yoshimizu (1997, pp. 96ff).